

**We acknowledge the use of OpenAI's ChatGPT as a supportive tool in drafting and refining portions of the text.*

THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

Faculty of Forestry

CONS 315: Community Sustainability and Environmental Change

Winter Term 1 2026/27

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

UBC's Point Grey Campus is located on the traditional, ancestral, and unceded territory of the xwm̓θkw̓y̓m̓ (Musqueam) people.

Title	Community Sustainability and Environmental Change (CONS 315)
Credits	3
Term	WT1: Tuesdays and Thursdays from 2:00 – 3:30 pm
Location	Forestry Sciences Centre 1202
Grading	Numeric (0-100%)

TEACHING TEAM

Instructor: Dr. Natalie Brooks

Dr. Brooks' research focuses on sustainability transitions, environmental governance, and community resilience in urban and rural systems.

E-mail: natalie.brooks@ubc.ca

Office hour: Thursdays 1:00 – 2:00 pm

Graduate Teaching Assistant: Rachel Singh

Rachel is a Master of Forestry student researching environmental communication and community-based sustainability planning.

E-mail: rachel.singh@student.ubc.ca

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course explores environmental sustainability challenges and the relationships between communities, ecosystems, and environmental change. Students will examine social, ecological, and governance perspectives related to sustainability planning and environmental decision-making.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

- Explain key sustainability and environmental governance concepts.
- Evaluate environmental case studies using evidence-based reasoning.
- Discuss environmental communication and planning approaches.
- Develop collaborative recommendations related to sustainability challenges.

COURSE STRUCTURE

The course will include lectures, seminar discussions, collaborative exercises, guest speakers, and group-based learning activities. Students are expected to attend class regularly and participate actively throughout the term.

ASSESSMENT, EVALUATION AND GRADING

Participation and engagement: 15%

Reflection assignments: 20%

Group project: 30%

Case study analysis: 15%

Final presentation: 20%

Activity	Weight (%)
Participation and engagement	15
Reflection assignments	20
Group project	30
Case study analysis	15
Final presentation	20
Total	100

IMPORTANT DATES AND DEADLINES

Activity	Date
First day of class	Sept 8
Reflection assignment 1 due	Sept 29
Group project proposal due	Oct 20
Case study analysis due	Nov 10
Final presentations	Dec 1-3

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Students are expected to submit original work and appropriately acknowledge all sources. Generative AI tools may only be used where explicitly permitted by the instructional team.

COMMUNICATION EXPECTATIONS

Students are encouraged to communicate respectfully and constructively in all classroom and online interactions. Questions related to course logistics should be directed to the teaching team.

WELLBEING RESOURCES

UBC provides academic and wellbeing support services to students. Students experiencing difficulties are encouraged to contact the instructional team or access available support resources.

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